HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

# My Plan for Replacing "I've already messed things up, so there is no point in stopping now."

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

## 1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

*Rate it now so you can see your progress later.*

"I've already messed things up, so there is no point in stopping now." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

## 2 My best question

*The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.*

- ☐ What is actually lost, and what am I adding by saying nothing left matters?
- ☐ Would I tell a friend it was pointless for them to stop today?
- ☐ What is one thing stopping would still protect?
- ☐ Where do I see "new every morning" arguing with "no point"?
- ☐ Who can help me with the next day, not the whole repair?
- ☐ If I am thinking about dying, who will I contact before today ends?

My own question: _____

## 3 My replacement truth

*The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.*

- ☐ What I have done is not the end of the story. God's mercy is new today, and stopping still matters.
- ☐ The past can be really damaged and still not be the last word.
- ☐ There is a point in stopping today.
- ☐ I am not condemned and finished.
- ☐ God's mercy is new this morning.
- ☐ I can ask for help without first repairing everything.

In my own words: _____

## 4 My Scripture

*The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.*

- ☐ Lamentations 3:22–23
  *"Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!"*
- ☐ Romans 8:1
  *"Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."*
- ☐ Isaiah 43:18–19
  *"'Do not call to mind the former things; pay no attention to the things of old. Behold, I am about to do something new; even now it is coming. Do you not see it? Indeed, I will make a way in the wilderness and streams in the desert.'"*

A verse I found myself: _____

# Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

## 5 My practice plan

*Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.*

### EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

### PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When you decided it was too late: Each day, write down one moment when you felt there was no point in stopping. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  *For example, Lamentations 3:22–23 becomes: "James can write: "His mercies are new this morning. There is still a point in stopping.""*
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

## 6 My action step this week

*Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.*

*Choose steps you can do safely. If you are thinking about ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. For help with substance use, call 1-800-662-4357, and talk with a doctor before you stop if withdrawal could make you sick.*

- [ ] If you want to die, call or text 988 or tell someone near you today.
- [ ] Make one appointment or one call to 1-800-662-4357. The point of the call is today, not a repaired past.
- [ ] Ask a doctor before you stop if withdrawal could make you sick. A safe plan is still worth making.
- [ ] Read Lamentations 3:22–23 in the morning before you review everything you have ruined.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

## 7 End-of-week check-in

*Bring this page to your next session.*

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I've already messed things up, so there is no point in stopping now.": _____ %

My truth: _____ %

## Daily practice tracker

| Day | Read my card | Said my verse | Used my reminder | A reason today still mattered |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mon | | | | |
| Tue | | | | |
| Wed | | | | |
| Thu | | | | |
| Fri | | | | |
| Sat | | | | |
| Sun | | | | |

## My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

| Day | Song I listened to | What it told me that challenges the lie |
|---|---|---|
| Mon | | |
| Tue | | |
| Wed | | |
| Thu | | |
| Fri | | |
| Sat | | |
| Sun | | |

## My Truth Card

**THE LIE**

~~I've already messed things up, so there is no point in stopping now~~

**THE TRUTH**

**GOD'S WORD**

*Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.*

## Prayer

*Lord, I have decided it is too late and there is no point. Your mercies are new this morning. There is no condemnation in Christ. Help me stop, and help me stay alive. Amen.*

*Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.*